

Answer Key

Grammar

Should have / Could have (criticism and regret about the past)

We use **should have + past participle** to criticise a past action that did not happen but would have been the right thing to do. We use **shouldn't have + past participle** to criticise something that did happen but was the wrong thing to do. We use **could have + past participle** to talk about a possible action in the past that was not taken.

Geçmişte yapılmayan ama yapılması gereken bir davranışı eleştirmek için should have + fiil3 kullanılır.

Geçmişte yapılan ama yapılmaması gereken bir davranışı eleştirmek için shouldn't have + fiil3 kullanılır.

Geçmişte mümkün olduğu hâlde yapılmayan bir eylemden bahsetmek için ise could have + fiil3 kullanılır.

When? Use this structure when giving advice about the past, expressing regret, or criticising a decision that cannot be changed anymore.

Geçmişle ilgili tavsiye verirken, pişmanlık ifade ederken veya artık değiştirilemeyecek bir kararı eleştirirken bu yapı kullanılır.

Positive

- Subject + **should/could + have + past participle**
- You **should have** listened to her.

Negative

- Subject + **shouldn't/couldn't + have + past participle**
- You **shouldn't have** said that.

Question

- **Should/Could + subject + have + past participle?**
- **Should I have** called him first?

Short answers

- **Yes, you should have. / No, you shouldn't have.**

Common mistakes

- ~~You should have went to the doctor.~~ → **You should have gone to the doctor.**
- ~~I should to have called her.~~ → **I should have called her.**

1. You _____ so rude to your classmate yesterday.

- a. **shouldn't have been** ✓
- b. shouldn't be
- c. don't have to be
- d. can't be

Criticism of a past action = shouldn't have + past participle.

2. She _____ (apologise) right away, but she waited two days. **(could have apologised)**

A missed possible action in the past.

3. 'I should studied harder for the exam.' is a correct sentence. — True / False **(Incorrect — I should have studied harder for the exam.)**

4. Which sentence expresses regret about something NOT done?

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- a. You shouldn't have shouted.
 - b. I should have called her. ✓
 - c. He shouldn't have left early.
 - d. They shouldn't have lied.

Should have + past participle criticises a missing action.

5. Rewrite using could have: It was possible for him to ask for help, but he didn't. (He ____) **He could have asked for help.**

6. Put the words in order: have / you / shouldn't / that / said
You shouldn't have said that.

7. We _____ (not / assume) she was angry; we never asked her. **(shouldn't have assumed)**

Criticism of an action that was done wrongly.

8. Choose the sentence with the correct meaning: 'You could have texted me.'

- a. It was necessary for you to text me.
- b. It was possible for you to text me, but you didn't. ✓
- c. You definitely texted me.
- d. You are texting me now.

Could have describes a missed possibility, not an obligation.

9. Rewrite as criticism using shouldn't have: It was wrong of them to hold a grudge for so long. (They ____)
They shouldn't have held a grudge for so long.

Might have / Must have / Couldn't have (degrees of certainty about the past)

We use must have + past participle when we are almost certain about a past event based on evidence. We use might have + past participle when we are not sure and are only guessing at a possibility. We use couldn't have + past participle when we are certain something was impossible in the past.

Geçmişte olan bir olay hakkında kanıtlara dayanarak neredeyse emin olduğumuzda must have + fiil3 kullanılır. Emin olmadığımız, sadece bir olasılığı tahmin ettiğimiz durumlarda might have + fiil3 kullanılır. Geçmişte bir şeyin imkânsız olduğundan emin olduğumuzda ise couldn't have + fiil3 kullanılır.

When? Use this structure when speculating about a past event, explaining evidence, or ruling out an impossible explanation.

Geçmişteki bir olay hakkında tahminde bulunurken, kanıtları açıklarken veya imkânsız bir açıklamayı elerken bu yapı kullanılır.

Positive

- Subject + must/might + have + past participle
- He must have left early.

Negative

- Subject + might not/couldn't + have + past participle
- She couldn't have known that.

Question

- Rarely used in questions; guesses are usually expressed as statements: 'Do you think she might

Short answers

- She might have. / No, she couldn't have.

have forgotten?'

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Common mistakes

- ~~He must have went home.~~ → **He must have gone home.**
- ~~She can't have knew about it.~~ → **She couldn't have known about it.**

1. The door is locked and no lights are on. They _____ home yet.

- a. mustn't have gone
- b. can't have gone
- c. must have gone ✓
- d. might have gone

Clear evidence supports a strong conclusion: must have.

2. I'm not sure, but she _____ (forget) our plans. **(might have forgotten)**

Uncertain guess = might have + past participle.

3. 'He couldn't have seen us; he was on the other side of the city.' expresses certainty that something was impossible. — True / False **(Correct)**

4. Which modal expresses the strongest certainty about a past event?

- a. might have
- b. could have (possibility)
- c. must have ✓
- d. may have

Must have shows the strongest logical certainty.

5. Rewrite to express impossibility: It's impossible that she said that. (She ____) **She couldn't have said that.**

6. Put the words in order: have / must / been / it / difficult

It must have been difficult.

7. Choose the sentence that best expresses an uncertain guess about the past.

- a. He must have left already.
- b. He couldn't have left already.
- c. He might have left already. ✓
- d. He has left already.

Might have expresses a weak, uncertain possibility.

8. They _____ (not / hear) us; the music was too loud. **(couldn't have heard)**

Loud music makes it logically impossible that they heard — couldn't have + past participle.

The Letter I Never Sent

Before you read

- Have you ever wanted to say sorry to someone but didn't know how to start?
- What makes it hard for people to open up about their feelings?

For almost a year, Deniz and her best friend Ela hadn't spoken. It all started with a small misunderstanding that neither of them had bothered to clear up. Deniz often thought about what she should have done differently. She should have called Ela the same evening instead of waiting for an apology that never came. Looking back, she realised she could have simply asked what had happened instead of assuming the worst.

One evening, Deniz decided to write a letter. She wrote about how she had bottled up her feelings for months, afraid that opening up would make her seem weak. She admitted that she shouldn't have ignored Ela's messages at the beginning, even though she was hurt. She also wrote that Ela must have felt confused when the replies suddenly stopped; there was no other explanation that made sense.

As she wrote, Deniz thought about all the small clues she had missed. Ela had seemed distant at school, and her friends said she looked tired and quiet. Deniz guessed that Ela might have been dealing with something difficult at home, something she couldn't have known about at the time. She felt a wave of guilt. She should have asked instead of staying silent.

In the end, Deniz never sent the letter by post. Instead, she read it aloud to Ela in person, her voice shaking. Ela listened quietly and then said she, too, wished she could have handled things differently. Neither of them had been a bad friend; they had simply been too proud to be vulnerable. By the end of their conversation, the heavy burden both girls had carried for months finally felt lighter.

1. Why hadn't Deniz and Ela spoken for almost a year?
- a. They had a small misunderstanding they never cleared up. ✓
 - b. They moved to different schools.
 - c. Ela was angry about a birthday present.
 - d. Deniz forgot Ela's phone number.

The text states the silence started with a small misunderstanding neither cleared up.

2. Deniz sent the letter to Ela by post. — True / False **(Incorrect — Deniz read the letter aloud to Ela in person instead of sending it.)**

3. Deniz guessed that Ela _____ (deal) with something difficult at home. **(might have been dealing)**

An uncertain guess about a past/ongoing situation.

4. According to the text, what does Deniz criticise herself for?
- a. Not calling Ela the same evening ✓
 - b. Telling other people about the argument
 - c. Writing too many letters
 - d. Being too talkative at school

Deniz says she should have called Ela the same evening.

5. Rewrite using couldn't have: It was impossible for Deniz to know about Ela's problems at home. (Deniz ____)

Deniz couldn't have known about Ela's problems at home. The Online English Lesson Secret - 11. Sınıf - Answer Key - Orijinal içerik, TYMM müfredatıyla uyumlu.

6. What does the phrase 'a heavy burden' most likely refer to in the text?

- a. A physical object Deniz carried
- b. The emotional weight of their unresolved conflict ✓
- c. A school assignment
- d. A family responsibility

Burden here is used figuratively for the emotional weight both friends carried.

After you read

- What could Deniz have done earlier to avoid a whole year of silence?
- Do you think writing a letter is a good way to open up? Why or why not?

Who Forgot the Cake?

Before you read

- Think of a time when something went wrong and people started guessing who was responsible.
- What clues do we usually use to guess what happened?

When the Aydın family arrived at their grandmother's 70th birthday party, everyone realised the cake was missing. Panic spread quickly through the kitchen. Someone must have forgotten to pick it up from the bakery, but nobody wanted to admit it. Uncle Kemal insisted he couldn't have forgotten, since he had written the reminder himself on a sticky note stuck to the fridge.

Cousin Aslı suggested that their younger cousin Mert might have taken the sticky note down while cleaning the kitchen that morning. Mert denied it firmly, saying he hadn't touched anything near the fridge. Still, his sister remembered seeing him near the fridge earlier, so he might have moved the note without even noticing.

Meanwhile, Grandma sat calmly in her armchair, smiling. She said it didn't really matter who should have picked up the cake. What mattered more, she explained, was that everyone had come together, worried and a little chaotic, just to make her day special. She reminded them that a missing cake couldn't have ruined a celebration built on love and family.

In the end, they discovered that the bakery itself must have made the mistake — they had accidentally given the cake to another family with a similar name. Everyone laughed with relief. Uncle Kemal joked that he should have called to confirm the order the night before, just to be safe next time. They ordered pizza instead and turned the missing cake into the best story of the year.

1. What was Uncle Kemal's argument for why he couldn't have forgotten the cake?

- a. He never uses sticky notes.
- b. He wrote the reminder himself and stuck it to the fridge. ✓
- c. He doesn't like cake.
- d. He was not at home that morning.

Kemal points to the note he wrote himself as proof.

2. Mert _____ (move) the note without noticing, according to his sister. **(might have moved)**

An uncertain guess about a past action.

3. The bakery gave the cake to the wrong family. — True / False **(Correct)**

4. What did Grandma say mattered more than the missing cake?

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- a. Finding out who was guilty
 - b. Everyone coming together for her ✓
 - c. Buying a new cake quickly
 - d. Getting a refund from the bakery

Grandma focuses on the family being together rather than blame.

5. Rewrite using should have: It would have been wise for Kemal to call and confirm the order. (*Kemal* ____)

Kemal should have called to confirm the order.

After you read

- Why do you think the family jumped to conclusions before knowing the real reason?
- How does the story show the difference between guessing (might have) and being certain (must have)?

A Difficult Conversation

Before you listen

- What would you say to a friend who hurt your feelings without realising it?
- Listen for how each speaker expresses regret or criticism.

1. Why was Buse upset with Kaan?

- a. He forgot her birthday.
- b. He made a joke about her presentation in front of the class. ✓
- c. He didn't invite her to the party.
- d. He lost her notes.

Kaan made a joke about her presentation publicly.

2. Kaan says he _____ (misread) the situation completely. (must have misread)

Kaan expresses strong certainty about his own mistake.

3. Buse told Kaan she was upset immediately after the joke. — True / False (Incorrect — Buse stayed quiet at first and only told Kaan later.)

4. What does Kaan say he could have done instead of making a joke?

- a. Stayed silent
- b. Complimented her work ✓
- c. Left the party early
- d. Asked someone else to speak

Kaan says he could have complimented her work instead.

Transcript (teacher use)

Kaan Can we talk for a minute? I've been thinking about what happened at the party.

Buse Sure. Honestly, I've been thinking about it too. I feel like I should have told you I was upset instead of just leaving early.

Kaan I noticed you left, but I didn't understand why. I thought maybe you just weren't feeling well.

Buse No, it wasn't that. You made a joke about my presentation in front of everyone, and it really hurt. You shouldn't have said that in front of the whole class.

Kaan You're right, I shouldn't have. I honestly didn't think it would upset you that much — I must have misread the situation completely.

Buse I think you might have been trying to be funny, but it didn't come across that way.

Kaan That's exactly it. I could have just complimented your work instead, but I chose a joke, and that was thoughtless of me.

Buse I appreciate you saying that. I probably should have told you right away instead of staying quiet and getting more upset.

Kaan Let's agree on something — next time, we talk about it immediately, even if it feels uncomfortable.

Buse Deal. Bottling things up never really helps anyone.

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The Empty Classroom

Before you listen

- Predict: why might a classroom be left in a mess after school?
- Listen for guesses (might have/must have) and impossible explanations (couldn't have).

1. What was the classroom like in the morning?

- a. Clean and tidy
- b. A complete mess with chairs and papers everywhere ✓
- c. Locked and empty
- d. Full of new furniture

The teacher describes chairs and papers on the floor.

2. Student A says the mess _____ (be) their class because they left it tidy. **(couldn't have been)**

Impossible conclusion based on evidence.

3. The cleaning staff were responsible for the mess. — True / False **(Incorrect — The drama club used the room for rehearsal and left the furniture moved.)**

4. What does Student A say the drama club shouldn't have done?

- a. Used the room for rehearsal
- b. Left the room like that without telling anyone ✓
- c. Cancelled the rehearsal
- d. Locked the door

Student A criticises them for not communicating about the mess.

Transcript (teacher use)

Teacher The classroom was a complete mess this morning — chairs everywhere, papers on the floor. Does anyone know what happened?

Student A It couldn't have been our class; we left everything tidy yesterday afternoon.

Student B Maybe the cleaning staff moved things around. They might have rearranged the desks for cleaning and just not put them back.

Student A That's possible, but the cleaning staff usually leave a note. Someone must have used the room after school without permission.

Teacher Actually, I found out the drama club used the room for rehearsal yesterday evening.

Student B That explains it! They must have moved the furniture to make space and forgotten to put it back.

Student A They really shouldn't have left it like that without telling anyone.

Teacher I agree. I'll speak to them, but I'm glad it wasn't anyone in this class — you couldn't have caused it since you weren't even here.

Revision

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1. You look tired. You _____ late last night.

- a. must have stayed up ✓
- b. should stay up
- c. can stay up
- d. stay up

Strong certainty about a past cause based on evidence (looking tired).

2. I _____ (apologise) sooner; I feel bad about waiting so long. **(should have apologised)**

Criticism/regret about a missed past action.

3. 'Bottle up' means to talk openly about your feelings. — True / False **(Incorrect — 'Bottle up' means to hide or not express your feelings.)**

4. Which word means 'to share private feelings or secrets with someone'?

- a. criticise
- b. confide ✓
- c. reassure
- d. overreact

Confide means to tell someone your private feelings or secrets.

5. Rewrite using couldn't have: It's impossible that he lied to us. (He ____) **He couldn't have lied to us.**

6. In 'The Letter I Never Sent', what does Deniz eventually do?

- a. She sends the letter by post.
- b. She reads the letter aloud to Ela in person. ✓
- c. She never speaks to Ela again.
- d. She gives the letter to a teacher.

She reads it aloud rather than posting it.

7. Put the words in order: shouldn't / it / like / have / that / left / they

They shouldn't have left it like that.

8. In the listening 'A Difficult Conversation', what does Kaan realise he could have done instead of the joke?

- a. Stayed silent
- b. Complimented Buse's work ✓
- c. Left the party
- d. Told a different joke

Kaan says he could have complimented her work instead.

9. She _____ (not / know) about the surprise; she was out of town all week. **(couldn't have known)**

Impossible conclusion based on clear evidence.

1. Which word describes carrying a heavy emotional weight?

- a. burden ✓
- b. excuse
- c. assumption
- d. reassure

Burden refers to a heavy weight, often emotional.

2. He tried to _____ for his mistake by helping her every day that week. **(make amends)**

Make amends means to correct a past wrong.

3. Which word means 'easily hurt or emotionally exposed'?

- a. vulnerable ✓
- b. considerate
- c. distant
- d. thoughtless

Vulnerable describes emotional exposure.

1. You _____ so harsh with your comment; it upset everyone.

- a. shouldn't have been ✓
- b. mustn't be
- c. couldn't be
- d. shouldn't be

Criticism of a past action = shouldn't have + past participle.

2. The lights are on, so someone _____ (be) home. **(must have been)**

Strong certainty based on evidence.

3. Rewrite using might have: Perhaps she forgot to bring her homework. (She _____) **She might have forgotten to bring her homework.**

1. In 'Who Forgot the Cake?', who was actually responsible for the missing cake?

- a. Uncle Kemal
- b. Mert
- c. The bakery ✓
- d. Grandma

The bakery gave the cake to the wrong family.

2. Grandma was very upset about the missing cake. — True / False **(Incorrect — Grandma stayed calm and said it didn't matter who should have picked it up.)**

1. In 'The Empty Classroom', who had actually used the room the evening before?

- a. The cleaning staff
- b. The drama club ✓
- c. Another class
- d. No one

The drama club used the room for rehearsal.

2. The teacher says the students _____ (cause) the mess since they weren't even there. **(couldn't have caused)**

Impossible conclusion, given they were absent.

1. Which phrase is most appropriate for softening criticism in speech?

- a. You always ruin everything.
- b. You could have handled that a bit better, maybe. ✓
- c. That was completely your fault.
- d. Why would you even do that?

Softened, hedged language is more appropriate for constructive criticism.

1. Which sentence best fits a paragraph expressing regret about a past decision?

- a. I should have listened to her advice. ✓
- b. I am listening to her advice now.
- c. I will listen to her advice.
- d. I listen to her advice every day.

Should have + past participle expresses regret about the past.